

THE G.O.A.T.

The Greatest of All Time

TEXT: Isaiah 9:6-8 (NKJV) ***“For unto us a Child is born, Unto us a Son is given; And the government will be upon His shoulder. And His name will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace.”*** ⁷ ***Of the increase of His government and peace There will be no end, Upon the throne of David and over His kingdom, To order it and establish it with judgment and justice From that time forward, even forever. The zeal of the Lord of hosts will perform this.”***

INTRO: The prophet Isaiah, writing seven hundred years before Jesus was born, prophesied that Messiah would have at least four names: ***“Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace.”***

THE GREATEST OF ALL TIME IS A

WONDERFUL COUNSELOR

Wonderful Counselor literally means “*a wonder of a counselor.*”

The word, Wonderful, means “*astonishing*” or “*extraordinary.*” A literal translation would be that He is an “*Astonishing advisor.*”

While human counselors are limited by knowledge, this Wonderful Counselor:

- Has never seen a problem He could not resolve...
- Has never seen a hurt He could not heal...
- Has never seen a battle He could not win...
- Has never seen a question He could not answer...
- Has never seen an obligation He could not meet...
- Has never seen a failure He could not fix...
- Has never seen a loss He could not restore...

No wonder the Prophet Isaiah called Him a
“Wonderful Counselor.” I declare this
“Wonderful Counselor” to be The Greatest Of
All Time!

THE GREATEST OF ALL TIME IS THE MIGHTY GOD

The word translated ***“Mighty”*** is the word
“gibor” meaning *“strong one”* or *“powerful
valiant warrior.”* Therefore, Jesus as Mighty
God becomes the God who fights for his people!

- He fights for the righteous...
- He fights for righteousness...
- He fights to save lives...
- He fights to save the lost...
- He fights to save marriages...
- He fights to save churches...
- He fights to save you and me...

If He is the Mighty God:

- We are on the winning team...
- He will grant to us victory for every battle...
- There is nothing impossible for Him...
- There is nothing impossible for us...
- The Kingdom is waiting for the victorious...

No wonder the prophet Isaiah said “*He shall be called Mighty God.*” I declare this “*Mighty God*” to be The Greatest Of All Time!

THE GREATEST OF ALL TIME IS THE EVERLASTING FATHER

In the Hebrew, the phrase “*Everlasting Father,*” literally means, “*the Father of Eternity.*”

In a very literal sense, He is the possessor of eternity, eternity belongs to Him! As a result, He gives us eternal life because it is His to give! (Larissa telling a Board Member “*My Daddy owns this whole place!*”)

Because He is our Everlasting Father:

- When we fail, He forgives us!
- When we fall, He lifts us up!
- When we are weak, He is strong!
- When we are lost, He is the Way!
- When we are afraid, He is our courage!
- When we stumble, He steadies us!
- When we are broken, He mends us!
- When we are blind, He gives us sight!
- When we are hungry, He feeds us!
- When we face trials, He is with us!
- When we face persecution, He shields us!
- When we face problems, He comforts us!
- When we encounter loss, He provides for us!

The ultimate goal of the everlasting father is a relationship with us! Someone said, “*A truly rich man is one whose children run into his arms when his hands are empty.*”

I would follow this Everlasting Father if He had nothing to give! No wonder the Prophet Isaiah called Him the “*Everlasting Father*.” I declare this “*Everlasting Father*” to be The Greatest Of All Time!

THE GREATEST OF ALL TIME IS THE PRINCE OF PEACE

Because we live in a democracy it is difficult for us to properly understand the gravity of what the role of a prince entails. Under a monarchy a prince:

- Is the son of a King...
- Is heir to the throne and the kingdom...
- Possesses authority over military forces...
- Determines how much authority his subjects will have...
- Is to be feared and loved simultaneously...
- Is justified in using whatever force is necessary to retain political control...

What does this look like in the Kingdom of God?

- Jesus is the only begotten Son of God...
“For God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten son...”
- Jesus is heir to the throne and the Kingdom... *“Heirs of God and joint heirs with Jesus Christ...”*
- Jesus has been given charge of everything...
“All power has been given to me in Heaven and in earth.”
- Jesus determines how much authority believers will be able to exercise... *“I give unto you power to tread upon serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy...”*
- Jesus is to be feared and loved simultaneously... *“The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom.” “You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, mind, soul and strength.”*
- Jesus is justified in using whatever force is necessary to maintain control of Gods plan for the ages... *“He will rule until He has put all things under His feet.” “Every knee*

shall bow...”

The literal meaning of the phrase “*Prince of Peace*” = “*The prince who’s coming brings peace.*”

He is the Prince whose coming brings peace!

- In the past, his coming made peace with God! His death on the cross satisfied the offence of sin, and set man in right relationship with God!
- In the present, those who come to him find peace in their heart and live at peace with others!
- In the future, his second coming will usher in a dispensation of peace! William Gladstone said, “*We look forward to the time when the Power of Love will replace the Love of Power. Then will our world know the blessings of peace.*”

If we are truly in relationship with the Prince

whose coming brings peace, we cannot allow war to stay in our hearts!

In their book, *“Let there be peace on earth”* Seymour Miller and Jill Jackson said, *“Let there be peace on earth and let it begin with me.”*

No wonder Isaiah declared Him to be ***“The Prince whose coming brings peace!”*** I declare Him to be The Greatest Of All Time!

CONCLUSION:

The Greatest Of All Time is:

- ***The Wonderful Counselor...***
- ***The Mighty God...***
- ***The Everlasting Father...***
- ***The Prince of Peace...***

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TEXT: Psalm 9:1-11 (NLT) *“I will thank you, LORD, with all my heart; I will tell of all the marvelous things you have done. 2 I will be filled with joy because of you. I will sing praises to your name, O Most High. 3 My enemies turn away in retreat; they are overthrown and destroyed before you. 4 For you have judged in my favor; from your throne, you have judged with fairness. 5 You have rebuked the nations and destroyed the wicked; you have wiped out their names forever. 6 My enemies have met their doom; their cities are perpetual ruins. Even the memory of their uprooted cities is lost. 7 But the LORD reigns forever, executing judgment from his throne. 8 He will judge the world with justice and rule the nations with fairness. 9 The LORD is a shelter for the oppressed, a refuge in times of trouble. 10 Those who know your name trust in you, for you, O LORD,*

have never abandoned anyone who searches for you. 11 Sing praises to the LORD who reigns in Jerusalem. Tell the world about his unforgettable deeds.”

INTRO: How does one become The Greatest Of All Time? That is simple – By doing great things! In Psalm 9 David enumerates the unforgettable deeds of the Lord – Which has earned Him the undisputed title of The Greatest Of All Time!

Notice his passion for God:

- I will thank the Lord with my whole heart...
- I will tell of the marvelous things you have done ...
- I am filled with joy because of you...
- I will sing praise to your name O Most High...
- Those who dwell in Zion sing praise to the Lord...

If we were to interview King David I believe he would tell us, Jehovah in The Greatest Of All Time!

David describes the Character of God in these way's:

- Enemies are overthrown by you, they have retreated...
- You judge in fairness...
- Your judgment is in our favor...
- You judge the nations...
- You destroy the wicked...
- When you judged cities, their memories perished...
- You reign forever, executing judgment from your throne...
- You judge the world with justice and rule the nations with fairness...
- You are a shelter for the oppressed...
- You are a refuge in the time of trouble...
- You can be trusted because you never abandon anyone...

Following these declarations the Psalmist say's
***“Sing praises to the LORD who reigns in
Jerusalem. Tell the world about his
unforgettable deeds.”*** Jehovah is
unquestionably The Greatest Of All Time!

I would like to take the next few minutes to tell
you how He has become The Greatest Of All
Time:

- God made the world and everything that it encompasses in six day's...
- God saved the world from extinction with a preacher of righteousness and a boat full of animals...
- God delivered Abraham from a life of pagan worship and used his family line to bring salvation to the human race...
- God used a fugitive from justice to delivered the Children of Israel from Egyptian bondage...

- With nothing more than a shout of praise, God flattened the fortified walls of a major city...
- God provided food and water to an entire nation for more than forty years... (God provided for them for 40 years or 14,600 days! This required - 58,400,000 tons of food at a cost of \$87,600,000,000.00 - 160,600,000,000 gallons of water were supplied at a cost of \$876,000,000.00 - Total cost of food and water would be \$88,476,000,000.00 - Transportation for food and water would require a freight train 26,309,200 miles long and would reach around the world 106 times!)
- In response to the prayer of a beleaguered prophet God sent fire on Carmel's altar and gave rain to a parched land...
- God robbed the fire of its heat so He could prove His point to a wicked King and deliver three obedient souls...

- God locked the jaws of hungry lions to deliver one preacher from the venom of misguided men...

I stand today to declare He is The Greatest Of All Time!

Jesus came into this world as a man anointed by the Spirit of God. He performed miracles not as God but as a man anointed by the Spirit of God!

- Jesus healed everyone who was sick in the house of Simon... (Matthew 8)
- Jesus healed a paralytic man... (Matthew 9)
- Jesus healed two blind men... (Matthew 9)
- Jesus healed a mute man... (Matthew 9)
- Jesus healed a blind, mute, demoniac... (Matthew 12)
- Jesus healed a multitude of people in Gennesaret... (Matthew 14)
- Jesus delivered a demon-possessed boy... (Matthew 17)

- Jesus provided the revenue to pay a tax bill from funds found in the mouth of a fish... (Matthew 17)
- Jesus delivered a demon-possessed man at church... (Mark 1)
- Jesus delivered Legion... (Mark 5)
- Jesus healed a gentile woman's demon-possessed daughter... (Mark 7)
- Jesus healed a deaf, mute... (Mark 7)
- Jesus fed 4,000 with seven loaves and a few fish... (Mark 8)
- Jesus healed a blind man at Bethesda... (Mark 8)
- Jesus healed blind Bartimaeus... (Mark 10)
- Jesus healed Peter's mother in law... (Luke 4)
- Jesus provided a miraculous catch of fish for His disciples by encouraging them to ***“Launch out into the deep an let down their nets”***... (Luke 5)
- Jesus cleansed a leper... (Luke 5)

- Jesus healed a man with a withered right hand... (Luke 6)
- Jesus stopped the funeral procession for the widow of Nain's son and raised him to life... (Luke 7)
- Jesus healed the centurion's son... (Luke 7)
- Jesus calmed the winds and waves by saying "*Peace be still*"... (Luke 8)
- Jesus healed a woman with a twelve-year issue of blood... (Luke 8)
- Jesus raised the daughter of Jairus to life... (Luke 8)
- Jesus healed a hunchback woman who had a spirit of infirmity for 18 years... (Luke 13)
- On the Sabbath day Jesus healed a man afflicted with dropsy... (Luke 14)
- Jesus cleansed 10 lepers... (Luke 17)
- Jesus reattached the ear of Malchus... (Luke 22)
- Jesus turned the water into wine... (John 2)
- Jesus healed the nobleman's son from certain death... (John 4)

- Jesus healed an invalid at the pool of Bethesda... (John 5)
- Jesus fed 5,000 men with five loaves and two fish... (John 6)
- Jesus walked on water... (John 6)
- Jesus healed a man blind from birth by spitting on the ground, placing mud in his eyes and commanding him to wash in the pool of Siloam... (John 9)
- Jesus raised Lazarus from the dead... (John 11)
- Jesus provided a second miraculous catch of fish by telling His disciples to “***Cast their nets on the right side of the ship***”... (John 21) (Someone is in the right place, at the right time, for the right purpose, seeking the right God)

It is a fact that cannot be disputed, He is The Greatest Of All Time!

Look at His mighty deeds in the book of Acts:

- A lame man healed at the word of Peter

and John... (Acts 3)

- Ananias and Sapphira struck dead... (Acts 5)
- The Apostles performed many wonders at Jerusalem... (Acts 5)
- Paul was converted by a blinding light and a voice from Heaven... (Acts 9)
- A man healed of palsy... (Acts 9)
- Peter raised Tabitha from the dead... (Acts 9)
- Peter was freed from prison by an angel, a bright light, his shackles being loosed, and the prison doors opening... (Acts 12)
- God killed Herod... (Acts 12)
- A sorcerer was smitten with blindness... (Acts 13)

- Paul healed a crippled man... (Acts 14)
- Paul cast out a demon of divination...
(Acts 16)
- Paul and Silas delivered from prison by an earthquake... (Acts 16)
- Multitudes of people healed by the hand of Paul... (Act 19)
- At Troas Paul raised Eutychus to life... (Acts 20)
- The venom of a lethal snake had no power over Paul on the barbaric island of Malta... (Acts 28)
- Many received their healing by the hand of Paul on Malta... (Acts 28)

Today I declare Him to be The Greatest Of All Time! What say you?

(Have people to give personal testimonies)

(WILL NEED THREE CORDLESS MIC'S –
TWO ON FLOOR OF AUDITORIUM - AND
ONE IN THE BALCONY – WILL NEED
THREE PEOPLE TO SERVE AS RUNNERS
WITH THE MIC'S)